

NAMRATA MEENA

Lead - Data Science & Forecasting | IIT Kharagpur Alumnus



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Namrata-Meena

Transforming data into decisions: Tech & Data Science leader shaping the future of FMCG and F&B. Experienced in delivering data-driven solutions with proven impact across India, North America, and South America.



Core Competencies

Team Leadership & Talent Development

Applied Machine Learning Strategy

Cross-Function Collaboration

Business Impact & Metrics-Driven Delivery

Forecasting & Demand Planning

Supply Chain Analytics

MLOps & Production Deployments

Statistical Analysis & Model Validation

Consumer & Market Insights

Market Trend Analysis

Risk Assessment



Technical Skills

- Programming & Analytics:** Python, SQL
- Machine Learning & MLOps:** ML Model Development, Model Explainability (SHAP), Feature Engineering, Prophet Model, Sequential Feature Selector, Ensemble Modeling, Model Deployment
- Cloud & Big Data Platforms:** Azure Databricks
- Automation & CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, Docker
- Forecasting & Advanced Analytics:** Demand Forecasting, P&L Forecasting, Volume Forecasting, Industry Trend Modeling, Crisis Analytics
- Tools & Frameworks:** Git, Postman, Python-Dash
- Visualization & Dashboarding:** PowerPoint, Excel
- Statistical & Modeling Techniques:** Multivariate Regression, Log-Log Model, Time Series Modeling, XGBoost, Random Forest
- Version Control & Collaboration:** GitHub



Profile Summary

- Machine Learning & Data Science Leader with **8+ years** of experience delivering business impact through **supply chain optimization**, **commercial forecasting**, and **ML automation**—including scaling forecasting systems across 20+ breweries in NAZ, APAC and SAZ regions.
- Currently leading a **cross-functional team of 8** at AB InBev's Growth Analytics Center, **managing end-to-end delivery** of advanced forecasting frameworks and ML-driven solutions.
- Experienced in **setting technical direction**, **mentoring** and **developing talent**, and **owning team performance cycles** (reviews, goal setting, career growth planning) to enable career growth.
- Expert in **Python**, **Machine Learning Algorithms**, **MLOps**, and **Forecasting Models**, with hands-on leadership in building scalable **ML solutions** (Dockerized models on Edge VMs, CI/CD on GitHub Actions, Azure Databricks deployments) to support **data-driven decision-making**.
- Stakeholder Engagement:** Led high-stakes forecasting initiatives including BudLight campaign recovery, FIFA sponsorship impact analysis, and Russia-Ukraine war-driven P&L forecasting — delivering explainable, high-accuracy models that directly shaped executive decision-making.
- Education Background:** Dual Degree (**BTech** and **MTech**) from **IIT Kharagpur**.



Career Timeline

Fractal Analytics - Mumbai | Data Scientist (AI/ML)
Jun 2018 - Nov 2020



AB InBev (Growth Analytics Centre), India
Manager - Analytics (Supply Chain Transformation)
Nov 2020 - Present



Work Experience

Anheuser-Busch InBev (Growth Analytics Centre), India
Lead Data Scientist (Supply Chain Transformation)
Nov 2020 - Present

- Leading end-to-end development of an Advanced Process Control (APC)** product to optimize the brewing operations, integrating real-time sensor data via Azure Stream Analytics to deliver predictive insights and automated process control for global brewery operations.
- Designed and deployed **scalable, Dockerized ML applications on Edge VMs**, ensuring seamless integration with on-site infrastructure and accelerating data-to-decision cycles.
- Standardized ML workflows** by leading the creation of reusable Python frameworks for feature engineering and deployment, **reducing model development time by 30%** and **ensuring consistency** across multiple use cases.
- Established CI/CD best practices** by streamlining **ML deployment pipelines** with **GitHub Actions**, improving delivery speed and model governance.
- Managed and collaborated a team of 10** including **Architects, Automation Engineers, and Business Teams** across NAZ, APAC, and SAZ regions to successfully deploy ML solutions, ensuring alignment, timely execution, and cross-functional coordination.
- Successfully scaled the ML solution across **20+ breweries**, achieving a **45%** increase in deployment efficiency and measurable reductions in operational costs.

Senior Data Scientist (Commercial Forecasting)

- Led Agile implementation** across the forecasting team of 5 data scientists, resulting in improved workload distribution and **enhanced prioritization of stakeholder deliverables**.
- Resolved key anomalies in the existing P&L forecasting framework and redesigned it** by deploying a **no-touch ML solution** on Azure Databricks with full **MLOps integration**, enhancing automation, governance, and reproducibility of forecasts.
- Implemented version control and **established PR review guidelines** using **Git**, enabling reproducible ML workflows, reducing errors, and accelerating delivery timelines through collaborative development.



Education

**Dual Degree (B.Tech. + M.Tech),
Agriculture and Food Engineering**
Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)
Kharagpur | 2018



INTERNSHIPS

Nielsen – Bangalore
Data Science Intern
May 2017 – Jul 2017

- Compared ML optimizers (Hyperopt, TPOT, Optunity) to fine-tune classification models on PMLB datasets.
- Developed methodology that improved accuracy by 7%, reduced cycle time by 90%, and increased productivity.

Key Achievement:

- Offered full-time role based on exceptional internship performance.

Fractal Analytics – Mumbai
Data Analysis Intern
May 2016 – Jul 2016

- Analyzed billed utilization and operational efficiency data using Excel and Tableau.
- Identified anomalies in employee allocation data to improve billing accuracy.
- Developed employee allocation insights based on project patterns and business unit trends.

Strategic Initiative: Crisis Analytics – BudLight Campaign Impact

- Designed a forecasting framework to analyze and project **volume recovery curves** post brand backlash, enabling leadership to assess impact and recovery scenarios for **BudLight** and broader AB InBev volumes.

P&L Forecasting Initiatives:

- Built **ML models** and **MLOps pipelines** on **Azure Databricks** to enable automated monthly refreshes of **Volume, Net Revenue**, and **VILC forecasts**, improving risk visibility for stakeholders.
- Replaced outdated **Log-Log models** with **Prophet models**, boosting forecast accuracy by **3 percentage points** and enhancing **model explainability**.
- Developed high-accuracy forecasting models ($\geq 90\%$) to measure the **impact of the Russia-Ukraine war** on **VILC costs**, supporting scenario planning at the monthly level.

Industry Forecasting for Strategic Planning:

- Built **explainable ML models** to forecast **beer industry volume** for a **3-year plan** covering **U.S., Canada, Brazil, and Argentina**, empowering the global revenue and sales teams to detect deviations and act proactively.
- Achieved **>98% model accuracy** by incorporating business context variables such as consumer sentiment, marketing strategy, macroeconomic indicators, and geo-political dynamics.
- Created a **feature selection framework** using **Sequential Feature Selector** with filters for **zero variance, missing values**, and **multicollinearity**, enhancing model robustness.
- Led an **impact analysis of the FIFA World Cup** on beer volume trends:
 - Built models to quantify incremental growth opportunities due to shifts in event timing and location.
 - Applied **SHAP values** to interpret key drivers' influence on forecasts at a monthly level.
 - Analysis helped the CEO and executive team in evaluating the business case for FIFA World Cup 2022 & 2026 sponsorship.

Key Contributions & Achievements:

- **Received 2 Annual Awards** for consistently delivering high-impact, multi-region analytics projects with exceptional quality.
- **Mentored and coached two interns**, both of whom earned **Pre-Placement Offers** after achieving excellent project assessments.

Fractal Analytics – Mumbai
Data Scientist (AI/ML)
Jun 2018 – Nov 2020

Key Responsibilities:

- Developed AI-driven demand forecasting models for **Hindustan Unilever**, enabling 4-week advance sales predictions to support production planning.
 - Engineered features based on time trends, promotions, and holidays; implemented **ensemble models** combining **XGBoost** and running averages.
- Supported **Philips** in operational, financial, and analytics planning by modeling P&L line items using multivariate regression and network graph analysis.
 - Built interactive simulation dashboards in Python Dash for real-time scenario planning.
- Designed a trade promotion optimization solution for **Reckitt Benckiser** to assess price sensitivity and product cannibalization.
 - Automated data harmonization for over 1,200 SKUs across 2 years and applied backward elimination to derive baseline and lift metrics.
 - Utilized price laddering to link sales with pricing trends, identifying top competitor overlaps and uncovering product **cannibalization** risks within the portfolio.

Key Achievements:

- Honored with the **Kaizen Award** for exceptional performance and innovation.
- Built a live planning simulator for **Philips**, reducing manual sensitivity analysis efforts by **90%**.



Personal Details

Date of Birth : 7 August 1994
Address : Bengaluru, India